

SIMCESIM — One Pager

How to run the hotel without knowing business yet.

The whole game in one breath

You run a 50-room hotel. Each season you set a few numbers, then see if you made money. Do it again next season. That's it.

The one fact everything rests on

You can sell at most **9,000 room-nights** a season (50 rooms × 180 nights). You'll never fill them all. An empty room earns nothing and can't be sold later — so the game is really: *fill enough rooms, at a good enough price, to beat your bills.*

The 3 things you set — always in this order

- 1 **Price** (Sales) — what you charge per night. Your biggest lever.
- 2 **People & upkeep** (Operations) — staff, training, maintenance.
- 3 **Money** (Finance) — loans, dividends, payment terms. Do this last.

Price first, money last — because the later steps depend on the earlier ones.

THE MOST IMPORTANT THING WE LEARNED FROM REAL RESULTS

Price drives how many rooms you fill — hard. From actual rounds: charge low (~\$125) and you fill lots of rooms; charge high (~\$250) and you fill almost none, and can lose money. Higher price = fewer guests, every time. The skill is the middle — high enough to earn per room, low enough to keep rooms full.

Picking a price when you have no idea

Look at what the hotel charged last season and how full it got (the “see last season” link). Start near that number. Nudge up a little if you were nearly full last time; nudge down if you sat half-empty. Don't guess from nothing — start from what already happened.

Don't aim for 9,000

That's the ceiling, not a target. Past seasons landed around **45–55% full**. If your estimate is near half of 9,000, you're being realistic.

How to know if you did okay

Open **Projections** after setting your numbers. Two checks:

- Is **net profit** positive? (Summer: yes. Winter: just don't lose much.)
- Does the **balance sheet balance**? (It should, automatically.)

If profit looks bad, change *one* number, check again, repeat.

Two cost traps to avoid

- **Don't over-hire then fire.** Letting staff go costs more than hiring them. Keep a steady team; use temporary staff for busy seasons.
- **Don't skip maintenance or training.** They cost money now but keep guests coming and let you charge more later.